of the French Legation since the announcement of the agreement (both France and America had denounced the terms of the accord and the secrecy in which it had been negotiated).[108] *As Cox explained to the Foreign Office, the 'attitude of Russian Legation is that [the] agreement [is] obviously most injurious to Russia, and that [the] Russian Legation, being in too weak a position to offer any effective opposition to it, look to [the] French to do their best to support Russia in connection "dans les interets des deux pays"'.*[109]

More worrying than the Russian Legation's overtures to the French, however, was the possibility that Russian officials in Persia, particularly the officers of the Cossack Division, might actively try to impede the treaty. Since March 1919, the British together with the Cossack Division had been sporadically fighting an uprising in north-east Persia by the Jangali group led by Mirza Kuchuk Khan.[110] By October, Lord Derby in Paris was relaying warnings from the Persian minister for foreign affairs that the Russian constituents of this campaign were stirring up intrigue against the Persian government, particularly in the northern provinces: 'They even go so far as to wish to create relations between Persian elements of disorder and Bolsheviks.'[111] The Persian prime minister himself was fearful of the Russian reaction to the agreement and asked Cox to implore the British government 'to recognise that it is in our joint interests that steps should be taken without delay to make position safe both as regards Bolshevist menace in northern provinces and in regard to Cossack Division, whose loyalty can now no longer be relied upon'.[112] British officials were quickly finding that their policy of supporting the Russian presence in Persia was coming back to haunt them.

Although it was the only force capable of repressing any disturbances in northern Persia, the Cossack Division had now become worse than redundant, constituting a threat in itself. Talk from Staroselskii of removing his force to Persian Azerbaijan and Gilan in order to put down the Jangali uprising, was met with suspicion by the British government. By taking his division from the capital, the Cossack commander would not only prevent his men from being absorbed into the proposed new uniform force, but he could potentially re-enforce his troops with men from the Caucasus and even liaise with General A.I. Denikin, the White commander in south